

FREE WEEKLY STUDY GUIDE

DEVOTION
in Season

WEEK 3 OF 8 · 18 TO 23 OCTOBER 2026

Your Work Is the Sermon

How to Glorify God at an Ordinary Job

SERIES: THE INFLUENTIAL SPIRIT
FOR PERSONAL STUDY, SMALL GROUPS AND TEAMS AT WORK

with Eryeza Kalalu

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This Week at a Glance

This guide goes with Sunday's podcast and the five Devotion in Season Daily episodes that follow it. On your own it takes about twenty minutes. With a small group or a team at work, allow about forty-five. Read the passages slowly, answer honestly, and use the space provided to plan your one task for the week.

God gave us work before the fall, sin made it hard, and Christ makes it worship again. People who never enter a church can still see God in the way His people do their jobs, and the Holy Spirit is the One who makes that faithfulness real.

SUN 18 OCT	Podcast: How to Glorify God at Work: Why Your Work Is the Sermon	<i>Genesis 39 · Colossians 3</i>
MON 19 OCT	Let Your Light Shine: What It Really Means	<i>Matthew 5:16</i>
TUE 20 OCT	Working When Nobody Is Watching	<i>Colossians 3:23</i>
WED 21 OCT	How Christians Should Talk About People at Work	<i>Ephesians 4:29</i>
THU 22 OCT	How You Treat People Who Can't Help You	<i>Luke 14:13-14</i>
FRI 23 OCT	A Prayer to Be Light at Work	<i>1 Corinthians 10:31</i>

The podcast comes out on Sundays at 8 PM East Africa Time, around 1 PM on the US East Coast. Devotion in Season Daily comes out Monday to Friday at 6 AM East Africa Time, which is late the evening before in the United States. Watch or listen on YouTube, Spotify and eryezakalalu.com.

READ

The Passages

“The LORD was with Joseph, and he was a successful man; and he was in the house of his master the Egyptian. And his master saw that the LORD was with him and that the LORD made all he did to prosper in his hand.”

GENESIS 39:2–3 · NKJV

What it meant first. Joseph was seventeen when his brothers sold him, and traders sold him again in Egypt to Potiphar, captain of Pharaoh’s guard. He spent about thirteen years as a slave and a prisoner (41:46). Scripture records slavery honestly, and it does not approve of it: Joseph later told his brothers, “you meant evil against me” (50:20), and Exodus 21:16 made kidnapping and selling a person a capital crime. The LORD is named three times in these verses, so the credit goes to God. When Joseph’s integrity cost him his position, the LORD was still with him in prison (39:21).

“And whatever you do, do it heartily, as to the Lord and not to men, knowing that from the Lord you will receive the reward of the inheritance; for you serve the Lord Christ.”

COLOSSIANS 3:23–24 · NKJV

What it meant first. Paul wrote to the church in Colossae, in what is now western Turkey, from prison (4:18); some modern scholars think a follower of Paul wrote it in his name. These verses first address “Bondservants,” people held in slavery in Roman homes (3:22). Scripture does not approve of slavery. Paul turns straight to the masters in 4:1: “give your bondservants what is just and fair, knowing that you also have a Master in heaven.” In 3:17 he gives the whole church the same call, so his words reach every believer at work.

MY ONE TASK

The task I usually rush or resent, when I will do it this week, and what I noticed when I offered it to Christ.

REFLECT

Five Questions

The questions move from easy to costly. In a group, give people time to answer, and let anyone pass who needs to. Please leave out names when you share stories.

1. What does your daily work look like, and which part of it do you find hardest to see as something God cares about?
2. Genesis 39:3 says Potiphar “saw that the LORD was with him.” What do you think an Egyptian official noticed in the way a young slave did his work?
3. Jesus says people will “see your good works and glorify your Father in heaven,” and in Matthew 6:1 He warns against doing good deeds “to be seen by them.” How can you tell which aim is driving your own work?
4. Paul tells workers held in slavery that they “serve the Lord Christ,” and he tells their masters that they “also have a Master in heaven.” How would your week change if you remembered both truths at your desk?
5. Is there a task you rush or resent, or a person at work you have been treating as unimportant? What would it cost you to offer that task or that person to Christ this week?

THE PRACTICE · ONE ACTION THIS WEEK

Choose one task you usually rush or resent. Before you start it, pray, “Lord Jesus, this one is for You.” Then do it carefully, as if Christ were your manager. When you finish, thank Him for the work.

THREE PLACES TO START THIS WEEK

THE HIDDEN TASK

Do the work nobody checks twice, such as the filing or the follow-up email, as if Christ were checking it, because He sees it.

ABSENT COLLEAGUES

When the talk turns cruel, say one kind and true thing, change the subject, or step away (Ephesians 4:29).

PEOPLE WHO CAN'T REPAY

Learn the name of a guard, cleaner, intern or driver you don't know yet, and thank them for their work.

If you've spent years treating your job as wasted time, 1 John 1:9 is for you: “If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.” **Your safety matters.** If someone with power over you at work is pressuring you sexually or threatening you, the fault is theirs. Get out of the situation if you can, tell someone you trust, write down what happened and report it through your organisation's channels or to the authorities. If you are in danger, contact emergency services. Faithfulness never requires you to stay where you are being abused.

GO DEEPER EACH MORNING

With the Daily Episodes

MON

Let Your Light Shine: What It Really Means · *Matthew 5:16*

What piece of work today could I do so well that someone might thank God for it?

TUE

Working When Nobody Is Watching · *Colossians 3:23*

Which hidden part of my job will I do carefully today as a gift to Jesus?

WED

How Christians Should Talk About People at Work · *Ephesians 4:29*

Before I speak or post in a work chat today, will my words give grace to the people who hear them?

THU

How You Treat People Who Can't Help You · *Luke 14:13–14*

Whose name at work do I not know yet, and how can I thank that person today?

FRI

A Prayer to Be Light at Work · *1 Corinthians 10:31*

Pray the prayer below. Begin your work with “Jesus, help” and end it with “to God alone the glory.”

PRAY

Lord Jesus, You worked with Your hands in Nazareth, and You finished the work the Father gave You on the cross. Thank You. Forgive me for the days I've treated my job as a waste of Your time. Forgive the rushed work, the careless words and the credit I took for myself. Holy Spirit, grow Your faithfulness in me. Let the people I work with see Your light, and let them thank the Father for it. Give me Joseph's faithfulness in the place You've put me, even the parts that feel unfair. In the mighty name of Jesus. Amen.

FROM THE BOOK

Day 12 of *The Influential Spirit*, “The Towel Strategy,” is built on John 13:14, where Jesus takes a servant's towel on the night before the cross. The Complete Formation Edition adds a companion journal and recorded declarations and prayers to the Formation Bundle. All three editions are at eryezakalalu.com, with launch prices until 31 October.

Support this ministry. This ministry is work too, and we try to do it heartily, as for the Lord. If God is using these episodes in your working life, you can share in it at eryezakalalu.com/give.

Next week: Would the people outside the church vouch for you? We open 1 Timothy 3:7. The Week 4 guide will be at eryezakalalu.com/study.